

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/14: The controlling question and the shape of the remedy

SYLLABUS ITEM 16, PRINTED VERBATIM: "Samkhya; Prakrit; Purusa; Causation; Liberation."

normalised: Sāṃkhya · prakṛti · puruṣa · causation · liberation

CONTROLLING QUESTION how can suffering be ended FINALLY and NON-RETURNINGLY?

+---- THREEFOLD SUFFERING (duḥkha-traya) – the exhaustive diagnosis -----+

| ādhyātmika internal / psychophysical bodily disease, mental affliction |

| ādhibhautika from other beings + surroundings ... humans, animals, environment |

| ādhidaivika from cosmic / elemental / unseen agencies (traditional class) |

+-----+

WHY ORDINARY EXITS FAIL

visible remedies (medicine, wealth, protection) -> relief is PARTIAL and decays

ritual / scriptural means -> the result is PRODUCED -> perishable -> repeatable

=> GRADED AS EXHAUSTIBLE, NOT DENOUNCED AS FALSE [trap 2]

THEREFORE the required remedy must be NON-PRODUCTIVE

it cannot manufacture a state; it must CORRECT A MISTAKE

correcting a mistake = KNOWLEDGE, not action

THEREFORE the knowledge must have CONTENT

"Sāṃkhya" is connected BOTH with ENUMERATION and with DISCRIMINATIVE/RIGHT KNOWLEDGE

=> the content is the TWENTY-FIVE PRINCIPLES (tattva)

+-----+
| ANSWER-GRABBING SPINE |

| Sāṃkhya is a soteriology forced to become a cosmology: a system promising release |

| by knowledge must first specify, exhaustively, what there is to be known. |

+-----+

! TRAP 1: do not present duḥkha-traya as a printed syllabus noun. It is the doctrinal

starting point that explains why the printed clause ends with "Liberation".

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/14: System identity and the textual ladder

RUNG	WHAT IT IS	WHAT IT LICENSES
Kapila -> Āsuri -> Pañcaśikha	traditional founders; works NOT extant in securely recoverable form	name the lineage; DO NOT quote them
ĪŚVARAKRṢṂA, SĀM̐KHYAKĀRIKĀ *	earliest EXTANT systematic classical text	THIS IS "SĀM̐KHYA" unless told otherwise
Gauḍapāda's commentary; Vācaspati Miśra, TATTVAKAUMUDĪ	major explanatory traditions on the Kārikā	supporting commentarial authority
Sām̐khyapravacana-sūtra; Vijñānabhikṣu !	later textual phase, often more theistic and reconciliatory	cite ONLY as a labelled later development; NEVER project it back into the Kārikā system

DOCTRINAL IDENTITY OF THE CLASSICAL SYSTEM

realist DUALISM: one unconscious prakṛti + many inactive conscious puruṣas
causation: satkāryavāda in the specific form of pariṇāmavāda
soteriology: kaivalya by viveka-jñāna
theology: NIRĪŚVARA – non-theistic / God-unproved, NOT "atheistic by proof" [trap 4]
status: ORTHODOX (āstika) school that nevertheless requires no creator

BOUNDARY WITH YOGA (bounded comparison, never a source)

Sāṃkhya supplies the dualist metaphysics Yoga substantially shares
Yoga owns mind-field, afflictions, eight limbs, meditative absorption,
God as a special conscious witness, the yogi's perception
=> Sāṃkhya = non-theistic and theoretical | Yoga = theistic and practical

ANSWER LINE: chronological hygiene is a philosophical commitment – a later theistic commentary cannot soften a non-theism the classical system deliberately argues for.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/14: Instruments of valid knowledge and the inferential burden

ADMITTED – EXACTLY THREE

REDUCED – absorbed, NOT rejected [trap 6]

1 PERCEPTION (pratyakṣa)

prativīṣayādhyavasāya: ascertainment
with respect to a presented object
through sense-capacities in contact

upamāna -> inference / testimony
arthāpatti -> inference
anupalabdhi -> perception's FAILURE-CONDITIONS
sambhava -> inference
aitihya -> testimony when reliable

2 INFERENCE (anumāna) – THREE KINDS

pūrvavat antecedent/cause -> effect clouds -> rain
śeṣavat effect/residue -> cause one drop -> the sea is salty
sāmānyato-dṛṣṭa .. general correlation; the connection between the terms is
NOT ITSELF PERCEIVED sun in different positions -> it moves

3 RELIABLE TESTIMONY (āptavacana / śabda)

word of a non-defective source, pre-eminently Veda/śruti, where the object is not
otherwise easily known

EIGHT CAUSES OF NON-PERCEPTION

excessive distance · excessive proximity · organ-defect · inattention of mind ·
SUBTLETY (saukṣmya) · obstruction by an intervening object · being overpowered ·
admixture with like things
=> mūla-prakṛti's imperceptibility is assigned to SUBTLETY; puruṣa is likewise
atīndriya rather than non-existent. IMPERCEPTIBILITY IS NOT ABSENCE [trap 7]

+----- THE SELF-IMPOSED DEBT -----+

both ultimates are BEYOND THE SENSES (atīndriya) -> perception cannot reach them	
testimony alone BEGS THE QUESTION against non-Vedic opponents	
=> THE WHOLE EVIDENTIAL WEIGHT FALLS ON SĀMĀNYATO-DṚṢṬA INFERENCE	
=> the five proofs of prakṛti and the five proofs of puruṣa ARE that payment	

+-----

PRESUPPOSITION: a general correlation of KINDS can license inference to an entity of a
kind never itself observed as a sense-object.

OBJ Cārvāka: vyāpti cannot be secured for a term never perceived.

REPLY: strict perceptualism cannot explain ordinary causal reasoning either.

OBJ Nyāya: legitimate but over-extended – atoms + Īśvara is more economical.

REPLY: adding God does not explain the MATERIAL CONTINUITY between cause and effect.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/14: Cognition, reflection and the two-way mistake

THE DOORS (dvāra) – external

THE DOORKEEPER (dvārin) – internal

5 COGNITIVE CAPACITIES

(jñānendriya / buddhīndriya)

hearing · touch · sight ·

taste · smell

MANAS coordination, attention, synthesis

|

v

AHANKĀRA ... appropriation as "I" and "mine"

|

v

5 ACTION CAPACITIES

(karmendriya)

speech · grasping · locomotion ·

excretion · reproduction

BUDDHI FINAL ASCERTAINMENT (adhyavasāya):

judgement and discrimination

sattva-predominant => TRANSPARENT

5 + 5 + 3 = THIRTEENFOLD INSTRUMENT (trayodaśa-karaṇa)

! a functional grouping drawn from within the 25 – NOT thirteen extra principles

PURUṢA – pure light, never acts

|

v reflection falls into transparent buddhi

+-----+

| puruṣa-cchāyā-āpatti / buddhi-pratibimba |

+-----+

|

+-----+

v

v

THE INSENTIENT (jaḍa) ORGAN

APPEARS CONSCIOUS

THE INACTIVE WITNESS

APPEARS TO BE AN AGENT

+-----+

v

FALSE APPROPRIATION (abhimāna)

"I am the doer / knower / enjoyer"

= THE PSYCHOLOGICAL ROOT OF BONDAGE

ORDERING TO KEEP EXACT: reflection is a STRUCTURAL FACT -> appropriation is the ERROR

-> bondage is the CONSEQUENCE.

! TRAP 10: reflection must NOT be described as a real modification of puruṣa; a really modified changeless principle could never be released.

ANSWER LINE: the intellect processes without awareness, the witness is aware without processing, and a conscious thought is the borrowed light of the second on the first.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/14: Primordial material nature – names, scope, necessity

PRAKṚTI = unmanifest, unconscious, uncreated, active primordial MATERIAL principle;
the ultimate MATERIAL CAUSE within Sāṃkhya's dualist ontology

NAME	EMPHASIS	ANSWER USE
-----	-----	-----
prakṛti	the productive nature of the principle	the general term
pradhāna	it is the CHIEF material principle	Śaṃkara's target in pradhāna malla
avyakta	UNMANIFEST before differentiation	contrasts with vyakta (manifest)
mūla-prakṛti	ROOT: cause of all, effect of none	fixes its place in the 1/7/16/1 grid

EXAM-SAFE DEFINITION: prakṛti is the AVYAKTA PRADHĀNA – the unmanifest chief principle
constituted by the three guṇas.

WHAT THE RESERVOIR CONTAINS ! "material" here means UNCONSCIOUS, not physical [trap 11]

+-----+	+-----+	+-----+	+-----+
buddhi	ahaṃkāra	manas + 10	5 tanmātra -> 5 mahābhūta
intellect	ego-maker	capacities	subtle -> gross elements
+-----+	+-----+	+-----+	+-----+

=> THE FAULT-LINE IS NOT MIND vs BODY. It is EVERYTHING UNCONSCIOUS vs PURE CONSCIOUSNESS.

WHY A SECOND PRINCIPLE IS FORCED

- 1 the world shows plurality, transformation, dependence, purposiveness, structure
- 2 a school accepting REAL effects, REAL bondage and REAL liberation needs a REAL material source; it may not dissolve the world into appearance
- 3 puruṣa is CHANGELESS and INACTIVE => it cannot itself become the world
- 4 => an ACTIVE but UNCONSCIOUS second principle is required

ANSWER LINE: Sāṃkhya's dualism is misdescribed as mind against matter; intellect, ego and mind sit firmly inside unconscious nature, so the fault-line runs between everything that changes and the one thing that merely watches.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/14: The five proofs of nature and the one-nature verdict

#	PROOF	ARGUES FROM	DELIVERS
1	bhedānām parimāṇāt "from the finitude of things"	finitude, delimitation, measurability of effects	a SUBTLER GROUND beneath limitation
2	samanvayāt "from uniformity in effects"	order and common pattern across diverse products	a COMMON MATERIAL BASIS
3	śaktiṭaḥ pravṛtteś ca "from operation due to power"	operation through a cause possessing the relevant śakti	a PRODUCTIVE POWER adequate to the full range of manifest effects
4	kāraṇa-kārya-vibhāgāt "from the cause-effect distinction"	cause and effect as distinguishable STAGES (distinguishable ≠ unrelated)	an UNMANIFEST CAUSAL MATRIX distinct from the manifest order
==	=====	=====	=====
5	avibhāgāt vaiśvarūpyasya * "from the undivided source of the diversified universe"	the diversified world is ONE INTERCONNECTED COSMOS	=> THE ROOT MUST BE **ONE** => THE 2019 Q8(c) ANSWER

WHY PROOFS 1-4 CANNOT DELIVER UNITY

several reservoirs could EACH be subtler than their products, EACH show pattern, EACH possess power and EACH differ in stage from their effects.
None of the four takes UNITY as a premise, so none yields unity as a conclusion.

THE BRIDGE SENTENCE THE EXAMINER WANTS [trap 12 if omitted]

the premise of proof 5 is the world's UNDIVIDED interconnectedness, so plurality at the root would FALSIFY THE PREMISE, not merely complicate the conclusion.

TEXTUAL CONTROL [trap 13]

Sāṃkhyakārikā 15 reads ŚAKTITAḤ PRAVṚTTEŚ CA – from causal POWER and operation.
It does NOT read kāryataḥ pravṛtteḥ. Misreading it converts a non-theistic argument into a DESIGN argument, which would be fatal to a nirīśvara system.

HONEST LIMIT: the verdict holds within Sāṃkhya's own inferential licence; a Nyāya atomist traces interconnectedness to COORDINATION among many causes, not to one origin.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/14: The three qualities, their states and their modifications

GUṆA	CORE CHARACTER	AFFECTIVE TONE	FUNCTION IN EVOLUTION
SATTVA	lightness, illumination, buoyancy	PLEASURE	revelation, clarity, manifestation, knowledge
RAJAS	activity, restlessness, propulsion	PAIN	energy, stimulation, movement, mediation
TAMAS	heaviness, obstruction, inertia	DELUSION	concealment, resistance, fixation, material density

! TRAP 14: NOT three separable substances. Three INSEPARABLE CONSTITUTIVE TENDENCIES of one prakṛti, present together in EVERY evolute in varying proportion.

TWO STATES OF THE SAME TRIAD

EQUILIBRIUM (sāmyāvasthā)
the three in exact balance
prakṛti = AVYAKTA (unmanifest)

|
v

SARŪPA-PARIṆĀMA
homogeneous: each guṇa transforms
WITHIN ITS OWN NATURE
=> nature is dynamic even when unmanifest
=> dissolution is NOT annihilation

DISTURBANCE
asymmetrical relations begin
prakṛti = manifest evolution

|
v

VIRŪPA-PARIṆĀMA
heterogeneous: the guṇas transform
ACROSS one another
=> ACTUAL COSMOLOGICAL EVOLUTION lives here
=> this is the mechanism of ALL causation

WHAT DISTURBS THE BALANCE

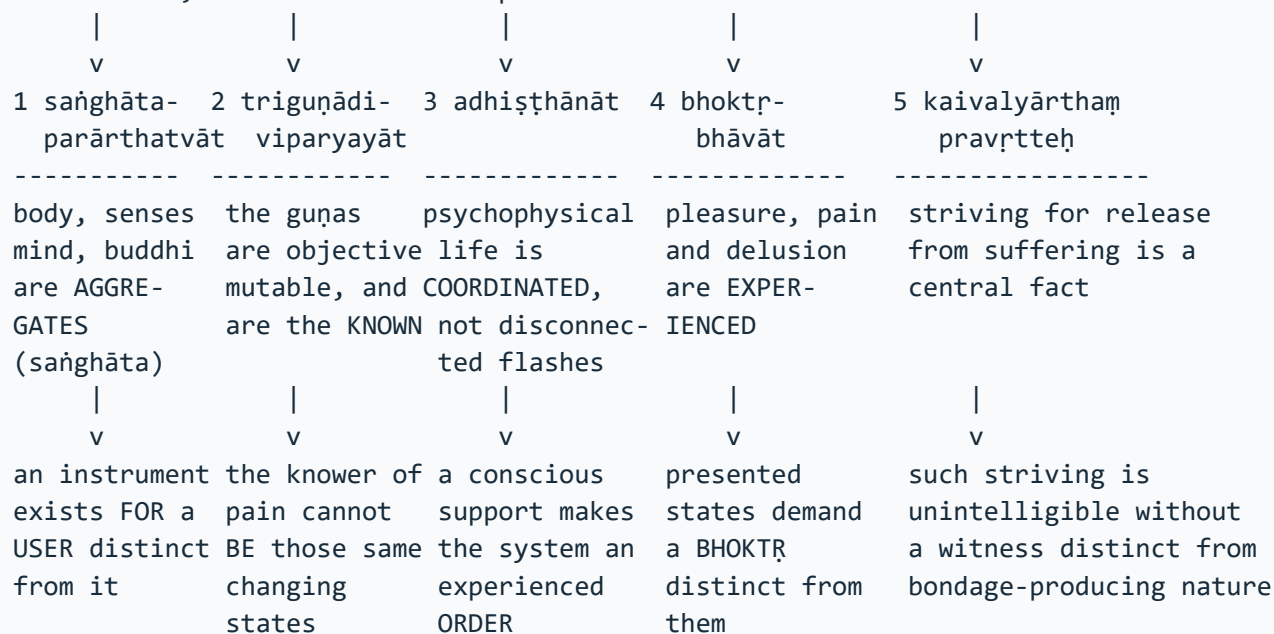
the MERE PRESENCE (sannidhi) of puruṣa – FUNCTIONAL ACTIVATION IN PROXIMITY,
NOT a mechanical collision and NOT an act of the witness.
=> this is the system's most exposed joint; see PANEL 14.

! TRAP 15: the 2021 demand is "three guṇas AND THEIR MODIFICATIONS" – stopping at the table forfeits roughly half the marks.

ANSWER LINE: one triad is made to explain physical constitution, affective tone and moral temperament together, so cosmology and psychology are not two subjects here.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/14: The conscious witness – nature and the five proofs

SHARED PREMISE OF ALL FIVE: the entire objective complex is UNCONSCIOUS (jaḍa), INSTRUMENTAL, and PRESENTED to experience.



+-----+-----+-----+-----+

v

A NON-GUṆA-CONSTITUTED CONSCIOUS PRINCIPLE = PURUṢA

FORM OF ALL FIVE: SĀMĀNYATO-DRṢṬA ANUMĀNA – from the general structure of objectifiable experience to a witness that is never itself an object

! TRAP 16: proof 3 is NOT a God-proof. It infers a PRESIDING WITNESS OF LIVED ORDER.

NATURE OF PURUṢA	consciousness = ESSENCE, not quality [trap 17]
	activity inactive, non-productive
	change changeless, immutable
	guṇas entirely beyond them
	status witness, seer, experiencer (bhoktr)

=> never bound in its own nature | never produces the world

EVALUATION (the 2022 directive): the proofs are CUMULATIVE, not isolated. Honest limit – they yield a SUBJECT-POLE, not yet an eternal, plural and wholly inactive witness.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/14: Plurality, purposive nature and the empirical self

PLURALITY IS NUMERICAL, NOT QUALITATIVE – every puruṣa is equally pure consciousness

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+-- FROM SĀṂKHYAKĀRIKĀ 18 – write these THREE first -----+
| 1 FIXED DISTRIBUTION of birth, death and sense-faculties: one witness would make |
| one birth every birth, and all would be blind when one is blind |
| 2 NON-SIMULTANEITY OF ACTIVITY: beings act at different times and in different |
| ways; one self would make all embodied streams act together |
| 3 DIFFERENTIAL CONSTITUTION BY THE GUṆAS: beings differ as sattvic, rajasic or |
| tamasic in temperament => distinct centres of experience |
+-----+
+-- SUPPLEMENTARY – reinforcement only, NOT a fourth phrase of the verse [trap 18] --+
| 4 DIFFERENTIAL LIBERATION: release of one would be release of all |
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OBJECTOR	OBJECTION	REPLY	RESIDUE
Advaita	differences lie in LIMITING ADJUNCTS (upādhi) => at most many CITTAS, not many puruṣas	bondage and release are NON-TRANSFERABLE; reflection needs distinct loci	clash of first principles
Nyāya	an inactive self cannot own moral desert	agency belongs to prakṛti's evolutes; ascribing it is abhimāna	moral subject becomes empirical
Buddhist	a changeless actionless entity fails arthakriyā => unreal	efficacy = SANNIDHI (mere presence)	is non-productive efficacy efficacy?
Internal	what individuates qualitatively identical witnesses?	inferred from non- transferability	THE WEAKEST JOINT – concede it

TELEOLOGY (puruṣārtha): prakṛti acts FOR the witness – four canonical images

MILK FOR THE CALF unconscious functioning can serve a purposive end

LAME AND BLIND sees but cannot act / acts but cannot see

THE DANCER retires once she has been seen

THE MODEST WOMAN concealment ends on being seen

OBJ: unconscious teleology is incoherent. REPLY: purposive functioning need not be
conscious PLANNING; the guṇa-structure unfolds in the witness's presence.

JĪVA IS NOT A SEPARATE TATTVA [trap 19] – it is puruṣa as empirically conditioned
through buddhi, ahaṁkāra, manas, body and the karmic stream.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/14: The twenty-five principles in exact evolutionary order

PURUṢA (25th, NOT an evolute) --- mere presence (sannidhi) ---+

v

PRAKṚTI (cause of all, effect of none)

|

v

MAHAT / BUDDHI – FIRST EVOLUTE

cosmic name = mahat · individual name = buddhi

! ONE principle under TWO names – never two stages [trap 20]

|

v

AHAṂKĀRA – the principle of individuation

|

+-----+-----+-----+

v

SĀTTVIKA LINE

manas (mind)

5 JÑĀNENDRIYA

hearing · touch · sight ·

taste · smell

5 KARMENDRIYA

speech · grasping ·

locomotion · excretion ·

reproduction

v

RĀJASA FACTOR

supplies ENERGY and operative

force to BOTH lines

! produces NO separate set of
principles [trap 21]

v

TĀMASA LINE

5 TANMĀTRA

sound · touch · form

· taste · smell

|

v

5 MAHĀBHŪTA

ether · air · fire

· water · earth

CORRESPONDENCE: sound -> ether | touch -> air | form -> fire | taste -> water |
smell -> earth ! do NOT import Advaita's pañcikaraṇa

COUNT: 1 prakṛti + 1 buddhi + 1 ahaṁkāra + 1 manas + 5 + 5 + 5 + 5 = 24 evolutes
+ 1 puruṣa = 25 PRINCIPLES

FOURFOLD CAUSE-EFFECT CLASSIFICATION – the fastest control on the whole list

cause but NOT effect prakṛti alone 1

BOTH cause and effect buddhi, ahaṁkāra, five tanmātras 7

effect ONLY manas, ten capacities, five mahābhūtas 16

NEITHER puruṣa 1

THREE FUNCTIONS TO KEEP APART (the 2024 second half)

BUDDHI determines / ascertains (adhyavasāya); transparent, receives reflection

AHAṂKĀRA ... appropriates as "I" and "mine"; false selfhood crystallises here

MANAS coordinates, attends, synthesises sense-data

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/14: Subtle body, transmigration and karma

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+-----+
| DOES NOT MIGRATE                                     |
| PURUṢA – never acts, never moves, is never really bound, liberated or transmigrating |
| => transmigration in Sāṃkhya is NOT the journey of a soul           [trap 24 guard] |
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+-----+
| MIGRATES: THE SUBTLE BODY (liṅga-śarīra / sūkṣma-śarīra)         |
| the continuing psychophysical vehicle between gross embodiments |
|   buddhi ..... 1                                               |
|   ahaṃkāra ..... 1                                             |
|   eleven capacities INCLUDING MANAS ..... 11   ! omitting manas gives 17 |
|   five tanmātras ..... 5                                   [trap 22] |
|                                     TOTAL = 18                   |
|                                                                 |
| CONDITIONED BY dispositions (bhāva) and the EIGHT TENDENCIES OF BUDDHI: |
|   merit <-> demerit           knowledge <-> ignorance          |
|   detachment <-> non-detachment power      <-> powerlessness    |
| described as primordially arisen within the evolutionary cycle      |
+-----+
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+-----+
| IS DISCARDED: THE GROSS BODY – produced from parental material; falls away at death |
+-----+
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THE PRESSURE POINT (state it; do not hide it)
moral ownership must be secured by the STABLE ASSOCIATION of one subtle stream with
ONE numerically distinct witness. Sāṃkhya ASSERTS that association; it does not
ground it. This is PANEL 9's weakest joint seen from the ethical side.

ANSWER LINE: Sāṃkhya buys the inactivity of consciousness by relocating rebirth – what
travels is not a self but a disposition-bearing subtle body, so the school must then
explain how a passive witness owns a moral career it never conducted.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/14: Causation – the pre-existent effect and the rival map

SATKĀRYAVĀDA: the effect PRE-EXISTS in its material cause; production = ABHIVYAKTI (manifestation), not creation from non-being. Sāṃkhya's specific form = PARIṆĀMAVĀDA.

#	ARGUMENT	EXAMPLE	COUNTER	REPLY
1	asadakaraṇāt a non-entity cannot be produced	no hare's horn; no oil from sand	Nyāya: equivocation between absolutely and not-yet non- existent	the not-yet effect must be SOMETHING deter- minate in the cause
2	upādāna-grahaṇāt a determinate material cause is taken up	milk for curd; threads for cloth; mango seed not sand	it is CAPACITY, not pre-existence	determinate capacity IS latent presence
3	sarvasambhavābhāvāt everything cannot arise from everything	curd from milk, never from water	restriction comes from the constitu- tion of causes	a constitution capable of only X IS X latently
4	śaktasya śakya-karaṇāt the potent produces only the producible	milk has potency for curd, not for cloth	Nyāya: potency is a RELATIONAL property	relational potency cannot explain determinacy
5	kāraṇa-bhāvāt the effect has the being of the cause	cloth is threads arranged; ornament and gold	Nyāya: the whole (avayavin) is a NEW substance	new properties are new ARRANGEMENTS (saṃsthāna)

THREE STANDING OBJECTIONS: effort pointless -> production is MANIFESTATION | cause and effect collapse -> they differ by STATE (avasthā) | world always as now -> only the CAPACITY is latent, never the gross effect

DOES THE EFFECT PRE-EXIST IN ITS MATERIAL CAUSE?

YES (satkārya orientation)

SĀMĀNYA pariṇāmaavāda | ADVAITA vivartavāda
real transformation | apparent transformation
cause = prakṛti | cause = Brahman
world = real evolute | world = appearance
mechanism = guṇa- | mechanism = super-
pariṇāma | imposition

NO

NYĀYA asatkārya/ārambha | BUDDHISM
prāgabhāva; new beginning | dependent
effect = a fresh product | arising,
continuity BROKEN | no root

=> SHARED PREMISE with Advaita; DECISIVE DIFFERENCE = PARIṆĀMA vs VIVARTA [trap 23]

! MANGO-SEED FORMULA: latent effect + material continuity + real transformation.

NEVER a miniature gross tree hidden inside the seed.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 13/14: Bondage, discriminative knowledge, isolation, non-theism

BONDAGE (aviveka)

buddhi reflects consciousness

1

V

FALSE IDENTIFICATION

1

V

the self APPEARS as agent, enjoyer,
sufferer and knower empirically

1

V

! bondage is NOT a real alteration IN
puruṣa; it is MISTAKEN IDENTIFICATION

FOUR CANONICAL IMAGES

lame + blind complementarity
dancer retires once seen
modest woman concealment ends
milk for calf purposive without
 intention

LIBERATION (viveka-jñāna)

the distinction between witness-consciousness
and guṇa-evolutes becomes STEADY

1

V

FALSE IDENTIFICATION ENDS

1

V

KAIVALYA – the ALONENESS / ISOLATION of puruṣa

! NOT merger • NOT annihilation •

NOT union with God • NOT identity with Brahman

TWO STAGES OF RELEASE

JĪVANMUKTI – the body continues by PRIOR
MOMENTUM; analogy: THE POTTER'S WHEEL that
keeps turning after the impulse ceases

1

V

VIDEHAMUKTI – final cessation of embodiment

STRICT FORMULATION: puruṣa is NEVER really bound, liberated or transmigrating; these belong to prakṛti and the subtle body, and knowledge ends FALSE ATTRIBUTION.

THREE GOALS THAT MUST NOT BE INTERCHANGED [trap 24]

kaivalya (Sāmkhya) = ISOLATION of the witness

mokṣa (Advaita) ... = IDENTITY with Brahman

apavarga (Nyāya) .. = CESSATION OF SUFFERING

NIRĪŚVARA – FIVE STANDARD ARGUMENTS

- 1 a God acting from desire or motive is neither perfect nor free
- 2 an eternally fulfilled God has NO MOTIVE to create a painful world
- 3 distributing results under karma limits divine independence; arbitrary distribution destroys justice
- 4 an immutable conscious God cannot be the MATERIAL source of a changing unconscious world under Sāṃkhya's cause-effect continuity
- 5 eternal puruṣas + prakṛti ALREADY explain consciousness and material evolution

! classical position = NON-THEISTIC / GOD-UNPROVED, not "no divine being can exist".

! Vijñānabhikṣu's later theism must not be projected back; Yoga owns Īśvara.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 14/14: Contact problem, Śaṃkara, PYQ route and verdict

THE PROBLEM: puruṣa is INACTIVE and prakṛti is UNCONSCIOUS – what relation is possible?

Yet evolution, bondage and liberation ALL presuppose one.

SĀṂKHYA ANSWER: SĀNNIDHYA – mere PROXIMITY or PRESENCE, not gross physical contact.

MAGNET AND IRON explains ACTIVATION BY PRESENCE

CRYSTAL AND FLOWER ... explains APPARENT CONTAMINATION WITHOUT REAL CHANGE

ŚAṂKARA ON BOTH: even a magnet EXERTS FORCE => puruṣa would not be wholly inactive;
the crystal explains APPEARANCE but not the INITIATION of the world-process.

WHY SĀṂKHYA IS PRADHĀNA MALLA (chief wrestler) – systematic strength, NOT contempt

A most sophisticated non-Vedāntic rival at the level of ULTIMATE EXPLANATION

B pariṇāmavāda is the NEAREST RIVAL to vivartavāda

C both appeal to a SINGLE ULTIMATE EXPLANATORY GROUND – unconscious prakṛti vs
conscious Brahman => the contest is DIRECT, so refutation must be detailed

FOUR OBJECTIONS: unconscious prakṛti cannot be the Upaniṣadic cause | the contact
problem is unresolved | teleology cannot rest on unconscious matter | tajjñā-type
"knowing-cause" texts exclude an insentient nature

=> PRESSED VERDICT: the dualism is UNSTABLE – it collapses toward monism or needs a
third mediating principle. A DEMAND FOR EXPLANATION, not a proof of Advaita.

PYQ ANSWER ROUTE, 2018-2025 (10 primary-owned + 3 routed)

2018 Q5(e) 10 .. Kārikā 18 x3 -> supplementary -> upādhi objection -> concede joint

2018 Q7(b) 15 .. real transformation -> Advaita x3 -> defence x3 -> first principles

2019 Q5(d) 10 .. puruṣa -> jīva is no tattva -> reflection -> critical limit

2019 Q8(c) 15 .. avibhāgāt vaiśvarūpyasya -> why 1-4 fail -> bridge -> Nyāya refusal

2020 Q7(a) 20 .. latent-effect formula -> five arguments -> reject 3 rivals by name

2021 Q6(b) 15 .. triad -> equilibrium -> sarūpa/virūpa -> trigger problem

2022 Q5(a) 10 .. five proofs -> shared premise and form -> cumulative -> honest limit

2023 Q5(b) 10 .. relation problem -> sānnidhya -> two analogies -> instability

2024 Q7(a) 20 .. evolution tree + 1/7/16/1 -> mahat = buddhi -> three functions

2025 Q7(a) 20 .. three grounds for the title -> four objections examined -> verdict

2021 Q5(a) 10 routed .. prāgabdhāva "no" vs latent-capacity "yes" -> equivocation

2022 Q5(e) 10 routed .. shared premise -> opposite commitments -> question-begging

2023 Q8(b) 15 routed .. prāgabdhāva -> its defensive work -> dilemma -> three replies

GRADED VERDICT

STRONG argued non-theistic realism · economical guṇa theory · a causal thesis
explaining determinate production · consciousness separated from cognition

WEAK the puruṣa-prakṛti relation · unconscious teleology · individuation of
attributeless witnesses · the obscure beginning of bondage

CONTESTED .. early theism? · is kaivalya purely negative? · Kārikā vs Sūtra traditions